

ISSUE

No

XII

TODAY'S EDITORIALS

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Daily 2 – 6
Latest Editorials



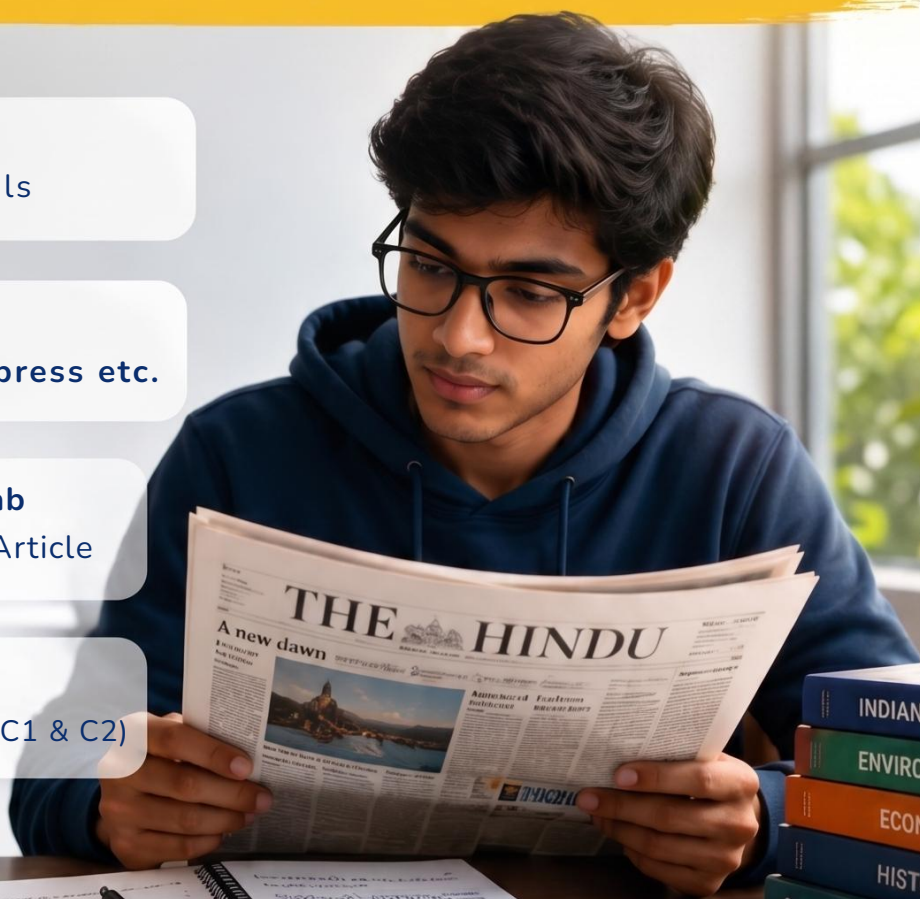
The Hindu,
The Indian Express etc.



Important Vocab
Highlighted in Article



Higher Level
Vocabulary List (C1 & C2)



ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERY DAY



RELEVANT
EDITORIALS
Handpicked Daily



VOCABULARY
LIST
Multiple Synonyms,
Tone & Part of
Speech



SMARTER
PREPARATION
Better
Understanding



STRONGER
RESULTS
Achieve Your Goal

CURATED BY PRATHU

PUBLISHED BY EZ

Saving faces: On protests, biometric surveillance

17 2026-08-23 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

India appears to be **normalising**¹ the technical ability to subject political gatherings to searchable biometric surveillance without first having settled, through legislation and **judicial oversight**³, the circumstances in which the state may lawfully do so. While the Delhi Police have continued to deny the use of excessive force and **manhandling**⁴ people involved in the

Cockroach Janta Party protests

, **contrary to**⁵ protestors' testimonies,

facial recognition equipment was present at the protest site

while the demonstrations were on. According to its

affidavit⁶ to the Supreme Court of India

, the police deployed a facial recognition system (including Artificial Intelligence-enabled cameras to scan faces in real-time against a database), a mobile surveillance van and a command and control vehicle, smart spectacles for identifying individuals **on the move**⁸, and drones and videographers; the van and the spectacles have been **tied to**⁹ private contractors. The police have also not addressed whether actual biometric processing occurred with every individual within the range of cameras. Even if the police discarded the images associated with **infructuous**¹⁰ checks, that the data may have been accessible to private contractors, whose **terms of engagement**¹¹ are unclear, is worrisome. However, no **statute**¹² governs the use of facial recognition systems; the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, whose data-processing obligations are not yet **in force**¹³, still makes broad exemptions for state agencies. The

Automated Facial Recognition System

of the National Crime Records Bureau can be used to identify criminals, unidentified bodies, and so on, and the Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act 2022 expanded the set of records that the police may collect from specified persons. However, these actions are still only allowed **vis-à-vis**¹⁴ specific groups of people.

Irrespective of the constitutional validity of the police's actions, the **chilling effect**¹⁵ on potential participants may also **curtail**¹⁶ the right to protest. The state has to pass a well-established **proportionality test**¹⁷ when interfering with the right to privacy. While the first question — the existence of a **legitimate**¹⁸ objective — already poses important challenges to facial recognition **en masse**¹⁹, the technology is **indiscriminate**²⁰ at the point of capture. After all, there is a less restrictive but equally effective alternative (e.g., conventional policing). At this time, far too many questions are unanswered — including over the data-processing agreements, access, legal provisions that authorised major decisions, and the expected rate of false positives — for the use of facial recognition with all protesters to be justified.

- August 22, 2026 12:20 am IST

Published: 2026-08-23 · Source: The Hindu

VOCABULARY 101

- 1. Normalising** (Verb)
standardising · सामान्य बनाना
- 2. Subject to** (Phrasal Verb)
expose to · के अधीन करना
- 3. Judicial oversight** (Noun)
court supervision · न्यायिक निगरानी
- 4. Manhandling** (Verb)
roughing up · हाथापाई करना या दुर्यवहार करना
- 5. Contrary to** (Preposition)
opposed to · के विपरीत
- 6. Affidavit** (Noun)
sworn statement · शपथपत्र
- 7. Deploy** (Verb)
station · तैनात करना
- 8. On the move** (Phrase)
in motion · गतिमान या चलते-फिरते
- 9. Tied to** (Phrasal Verb)
linked to · से जुड़ा हुआ
- 10. Infructuous** (Adjective)
fruitless · निष्फल या निरर्थक
- 11. Terms of engagement** (Noun)
ground rules · संबद्धता या अनुबंध की शर्तें
- 12. Statute** (Noun)
enacted law · कानून या संविधि
- 13. In force** (Phrase)
operative · प्रभावी या लागू
- 14. Vis-à-vis** (Preposition)
in relation to · के सम्मुख या के संबंध में
- 15. Chilling effect** (Noun)
deterrent impact · हतोत्साहित करने वाला प्रभाव
- 16. Curtail** (Verb)
restrict · घटाना या सीमित करना
- 17. Proportionality test** (Noun)
fair balance check · अनुपातिकता परीक्षण
- 18. Legitimate** (Adjective)
lawful · वैध या न्यायसंगत
- 19. En masse** (Adverb)
all together · सामूहिक रूप से
- 20. Indiscriminate** (Adjective)
unselective · अंधाधुंध या बिना भेदभाव के
- 21. False positive** (Noun)
erroneous match · गलत सकारात्मक परिणाम

🔔 Daily Revision

Detailed definitions & grammar rules on Page 4.

→ Join Ez Editorials

EDITORIAL STANCE & SUMMARY

tone: critical (finding fault)

The author adopts a critical and cautionary tone to highlight the perils of unchecked state deployment of facial recognition technology at political protests. Emphasising the absence of statutory safeguards and privacy protections, the editorial argues that indiscriminate biometric tracking suppresses democratic dissent and breaches constitutional proportionality.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Normalising VERB Negative	सामान्य बनाना Making an unusual, questionable, or intrusive practice appear ordinary and acceptable. Memory Hook: Making something abnormal seem 'normal' through repeated use.	standardising, routinising, legitimising	anomalising, exceptionalising, prohibiting
2	Manhandling VERB Negative	हाथापाई करना या दुर्व्यवहार करना Handling someone roughly, clumsily, or with excessive physical force. Memory Hook: Handling someone using brute 'man' force without care or respect.	maltreating, mistreating, roughing up	handling gently, protecting, safeguarding
3	Deploy VERB Neutral	तैनात करना To bring resources, technology, or forces into effective action or position. Memory Hook: De-employ elsewhere to re-position for strategic use.	station, position, mobilise	withdraw, recall, withhold
4	Curtail VERB Negative	घटाना या सीमित करना To reduce in extent, quantity, or duration; impose a restriction on. Memory Hook: Cur-tail: cut the tail off to make it shorter.	restrict, truncate, abridge	expand, extend, augment
5	Legitimate ADJECTIVE Positive	वैध या न्यायसंगत Conforming to the law, rules, logic, or accepted standards. Memory Hook: Root 'legis' meaning law — conforming strictly to law and reason.	lawful, justifiable, valid	illegitimate, unlawful, spurious
6	Indiscriminate ADJECTIVE Negative	अंधाधुंध या बिना भेदभाव के Done at random or without careful judgement; failing to distinguish between targets. Memory Hook: In (not) + discriminate (distinguish) = sweeping everyone without distinction.	unselective, sweeping, arbitrary	selective, discriminating, targeted

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

Subject to (के अधीन करना): To cause or force someone or something to undergo or be vulnerable to an action or treatment.
Contrary to (के विपरीत): In direct opposition or disagreement with something.
Tied to (से जुड़ा हुआ): Associated with, linked to, or dependent upon a specific party or condition.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

Judicial oversight (न्यायिक निगरानी): Supervision and review of executive actions or policies by courts to ensure constitutional compliance.
Affidavit (शपथपत्र): A written statement confirmed by oath or affirmation for use as evidence in court.
Infructuous (निष्फल या निरर्थक): Fruitless, ineffective, or yielding no practical result or benefit.
Statute (कानून या संविधि): A formal written enactment of a legislative authority that governs a state or city.
Proportionality test (अनुपातिकता परीक्षण): A legal principle used to determine whether an interference with a basic right is justified, suitable, necessary, and balanced.
False positive (गलत सकारात्मक परिणाम): A test result which incorrectly indicates that a particular condition, attribute, or identity is present.

IDIOMS & PHRASES

On the move (गतिमान या चलते-फिरते): Progressing, active, or physically moving from one place to another.
Terms of engagement (संबद्धता या अनुबंध की शर्तें): The specific contractual conditions, rules, or boundaries under which an operation or relationship occurs.
In force (प्रभावी या लागू): Being currently valid, binding, or operational in law.
Chilling effect (हतोत्साहित करने वाला प्रभाव): A discouraging or deterring effect on the legitimate exercise of natural or legal rights through fear of consequences.

FOREIGN WORDS

Vis-à-vis (के सम्मुख या के संबंध में): In relation to, with regard to, or compared with.
En masse (सामूहिक रूप से): In a group; all together as a whole body.

STUDY TIP: Pay special attention to the fixed prepositions and contextual connotation tags when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

Noise annoys: On noise and the Patna High Court order

2026-08-23 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

In a February 2025 hearing in the matter of Surendra Prasad vs State of Bihar

, the Patna High Court acknowledged DJ trolleys and loudspeakers to be a major source of noise in Patna. After criticising the Bihar State Pollution Control Board (BSPCB) for failing to curb the **menace**¹, Justice Rajiv Roy directed the BSPCB to obtain reports from the police about permissions granted to operators of these noise sources and the action taken. In October, the police said they had seized equipment, levied fines, and so on over three months in Patna, Barh, and Fatuha but had taken no action in Masaurhi, a picture Justice Roy called “unbelievable” for suggesting that there were no noise violations there. In the course of these hearings, Justice Roy also summoned police officers and **upbraided**² **boilerplate**³ affidavits, among others. The High Court’s August 14 order was a continuation of this escalation, **culminating**⁴ — for now — in Statewide directives on the emission of high-decibel noise. Effectively, the High Court’s actions illustrate how **dismal**⁵ enforcement has become despite the existence of comprehensive laws. Courts have repeatedly said that people have a right under Article 21 to be protected from unlawful noise. Today, with **episodic**⁶ enforcement having become **endemic**⁷, the Patna High Court becoming a **quasi**⁸-regulator is, at least as a **stopgap measure**⁹, **credible**¹⁰.

It is **absurd**¹¹ to expect the public to complain about every DJ or horn before the police can respond. The High Court’s directions to the authorities to pursue routine rather than complaints-based enforcement and to have DJs, sound-system operators, and event halls register themselves with the subdivisional authorities are the sort of proactive enforcement that regulating noise pollution in particular **warrants**¹². In fact, the High Court’s order also **touched on**¹³ a practical, everyday understanding of how loud-noise violations occur when it directed loudspeakers to stop playing at 9.55 p.m., five minutes before the law’s 10 p.m. cut-off, effectively allowing time for operators to **wind up**¹⁴ rather than permit the deceptively **innocuous**¹⁵ practice of carrying on past 10 p.m. because “it is just a few minutes”. Loud noise is often produced by ordinary social events such as festivals, weddings, political campaigns, and religious events, and enforcing rules creates **friction with**¹⁶ people who believe they have a right to practise their culture **as they deem fit**¹⁷. Also, governments have an incentive to tolerate, rather than **antagonise**¹⁸, their **constituents**¹⁹. At the same time, having operators register themselves so that officials can regulate all of them equally rather than **sporadically**²⁰ can also eliminate selective interventions. **In the final analysis**²¹, the success of the High Court’s latest order should be measured by whether the State develops a consistent habit of enforcement.

- August 22, 2026 12:10 am IST

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VOCABULARY 101

- Menace** (Noun)
threat · खतरा
- Upbraided** (Verb)
scolded · फटकारना
- Boilerplate** (Adjective)
standardised · घिसा-पिटा
- Culminating** (Verb)
climaxing · चरम सीमा पर पहुँचना
- Dismal** (Adjective)
gloomy · निराशाजनक
- Episodic** (Adjective)
irregular · अनियंत्रित
- Endemic** (Adjective)
widespread · स्थानिक
- Quasi** (Foreign Term)
semi- · अर्ध
- Stopgap measure** (Phrase)
temporary fix · कामचलाऊ उपाय
- Creditable** (Adjective)
praiseworthy · सराहनीय
- Absurd** (Adjective)
ridiculous · बेतुका
- Warrants** (Verb)
justifies · औचित्य सिद्ध करना
- Touched on** (Phrasal Verb)
mentioned · जिक्र करना
- Wind up** (Phrasal Verb)
conclude · समाप्त करना
- Innocuous** (Adjective)
harmless · अहानिकर
- Friction with** (Prepositional Phrase)
conflict with · तनाव
- As they deem fit** (Phrase)
at discretion · जैसा वे उचित समझें
- Antagonise** (Verb)
provoke · शत्रु बनाना
- Constituents** (Noun)
voters · मतदाता
- Sporadically** (Adverb)
occasionally · छिटपुट
- In the final analysis** (Phrase)
ultimately · अंततः

Daily Revision

Detailed definitions & grammar rules on Page 6.

→ Join Ez Editorials

EDITORIAL STANCE & SUMMARY

TONE: ANALYTICAL ((CAREFULLY EXAMINING))

The author adopts an analytical tone to evaluate the Patna High Court's directives regarding noise pollution in Bihar. The piece highlights how administrative inaction and sporadic police action forced the judiciary to step in as a quasi-regulator. Ultimately, the author emphasizes that long-term success depends on executive authorities developing a routine habit of uniform enforcement rather than relying on judicial stopgap measures.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Menace NOUN Negative	खतरा A person, thing, or situation that causes serious harm, danger, or public nuisance. Memory Hook: Sounds like 'Dennis the Menace' — a constant source of trouble, danger, or public annoyance.	threat, danger, hazard	blessing, safeguard, protection
2	Upbraided VERB Negative	फटकारना Reprimanded, censured, or scolded someone severely for a wrongdoing or shortcoming. Memory Hook: Up + braid — pulling someone up sharply and braiding them with harsh reprimands.	reprimanded, chided, admonished	praised, commended, lauded
3	Culminating VERB Neutral	चरम सीमा पर पहुँचना Reaching the highest point or final decisive stage of a process or development. Memory Hook: Think of 'climax' — reaching the final peak or ultimate result of a series of actions.	climaxing, terminating, concluding	commencing, initiating, originating
4	Dismal ADJECTIVE Negative	निराशाजनक Disappointingly bad, shockingly poor in standard, or gloomily depressing. Memory Hook: Dis + dismal sounds like receiving 'this malevolent' news — depressing and of very poor quality.	appalling, dreadful, depressing	encouraging, promising, excellent
5	Episodic ADJECTIVE Neutral	अनियंत्रित Occurring irregularly, sporadically, or at separate loose intervals. Memory Hook: Like TV episodes — occurring in separate, occasional bursts rather than continuously.	sporadic, intermittent, fitful	continuous, uninterrupted, sustained
6	Creditable ADJECTIVE Positive	सराहनीय Deserving public praise, respect, or approval, though not necessarily outstanding. Memory Hook: Credit + able — deserving of public credit or appreciation for a good effort.	praiseworthy, commendable, laudable	discreditable, blameworthy, reprehensible
7	Absurd ADJECTIVE Negative	बेतुका Wildly unreasonable, illogical, or inappropriate to the point of being laughable. Memory Hook: Ab + surd (irrational number in mathematics) — completely illogical and senseless.	preposterous, ludicrous, irrational	sensible, logical, reasonable
8	Warrants VERB Neutral	औचित्य सिद्ध करना Makes a particular course of action necessary, appropriate, or justified. Memory Hook: A judicial warrant gives justification; to warrant an action means to justify it.	justifies, necessitates, calls for	discourages, disapproves, precludes
9	Innocuous ADJECTIVE Neutral	अहानिकर Not harmful, offensive, or dangerous; seemingly safe and benign. Memory Hook: In (not) + nocuous (harmful/noxious) — completely free from harmful effects.	harmless, inoffensive, benign	harmful, deleterious, obnoxious
10	Antagonise VERB Negative	शत्रु बनाना Cause someone to become hostile, angry, or opposed to oneself. Memory Hook: Turn someone into an antagonist (enemy) by provoking them. Note British 'ise' spelling.	provoke, alienate, estrange	mollify, placate, conciliate
11	Sporadically ADVERB Neutral	छिटपुट Occurring occasionally, irregularly, or in scattered and random instances. Memory Hook: Spores blown randomly in the wind — occurring at scattered and unpredictable times.	intermittently, infrequently, fitfully	consistently, continuously, regularly

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

Friction with (तनाव): Conflict, tension, or disagreement arising between opposing entities or public groups.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

Boilerplate (बिसा-फिरा): Standardised, unoriginal text or formulaic responses used repeatedly without specific thought.
Endemic (स्थानिक): Regularly found and deeply ingrained within a particular group, area, or system.
Constituents (मतदाता): Members of a constituency who elect an official to represent them in public office.

FOREIGN WORDS

Quasi (अर्ध): Seemingly, apparently, or functioning to a partial degree like something else (Latin origin).

PHRASAL VERBS

Touched on (ज़िक्र करना): Mentioned or addressed a topic briefly in speech, writing, or legal ruling.
Wind up (समाप्त करना): To bring an activity, event, or operation to a final conclusion.

IDIOMS & PHRASES

Stopgap measure (कामचलाऊ उपाय): A temporary expedient or substitute adopted until a permanent arrangement can be made.
As they deem fit (जैसा वे उचित समझें): In whatever manner a person or group considers appropriate based on their personal judgment.
In the final analysis (अंततः): When all relevant factors have been fully considered; ultimately or in conclusion.

STUDY TIP: Pay special attention to the fixed prepositions and contextual connotation tags when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

On interest rates, Monetary Policy Committee can't be both dovish and hawkish

2026-08-23 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

In its last meeting, the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee voted **unanimously**¹ to keep the **benchmark**² repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent. The tone of the policy was more **dovish**³ than many at that time had expected. This led to a view among analysts that rate hikes were not **imminent**⁴ even as inflation was **projected**⁵ to be above target. But the minutes of the same meeting, released a few days ago, suggest that the current situation is unlikely to be maintained over the near term. The **divergence**⁶ is **striking**⁷. The members from the central bank on the committee displayed a distinct **hawkishness**⁸. As a report by economists at the SBI says, "the Governor MPC minutes statement shows **inclination towards**⁹ **policy tightening**¹⁰... DG, RBI calls for a possible rate hike later in the year, while ED, RBI just stops just short..." Alongside, external members on the committee like Saugata Bhattacharya and Ram Singh have drawn attention to the real interest rate. The RBI's own inflation projections point towards negative real interest rates — it has pegged inflation at 5.9 per cent in the third quarter, 5.5 per cent in the fourth quarter, and 5.3 per cent in the first quarter of the next financial year. This implies that real interest rates are negative on a forward basis. Negative real rates are for **stimulating**¹⁴ economic activity, unlike the stated **neutral stance**¹⁵ the committee has adopted, which as the RBI Governor has noted in the past, implies no support for economic activity or for controlling inflation. This is also odd considering the central bank's views on "**resilient**¹⁶ growth." "Growth continues to be supported by **resilient**¹⁶ domestic demand, **sustained**¹⁷ expansion in manufacturing and services activity, and **robust**¹⁸ exports," it notes. Across the world, central banks are grappling with uncertainty over inflation and the course of monetary policy. In the US, for instance, even as the Federal Reserve maintained interest rates in July, the path of monetary policy remains unclear. According to the minutes of the Fed meeting, "several participants favoured an increase of 25 **basis points**²⁰ in the target range". By the time the MPC meets next in October, there should be more clarity on agriculture and the **trajectory**²¹ of inflation. The central bank's inflation projections will **shed light on**²² its expectations of the **underlying**²³ price pressures in the economy going forward. These could lead to adjustments in the policy rate.

VOCABULARY 101

1. **Unanimously** (Adverb)
undividedly · सर्वसम्मति से
2. **Benchmark** (Noun)
standard · मानक / मानदंड
3. **Dovish** (Adjective)
peaceful · नरम दल का / उदारवादी (आर्थिक नीति में)
4. **Imminent** (Adjective)
impending · सन्निकट / शीघ्र होने वाला
5. **Projected** (Verb)
predicted · अनुमानित / प्रक्षेपित
6. **Divergence** (Noun)
difference · विचलन / भिन्नता
7. **Striking** (Adjective)
noticeable · आश्चर्यजनक / विशिष्ट रूप से ध्यान खींचने वाला
8. **Hawkishness** (Noun)
aggressiveness · सख्ती / आक्रामकता (आर्थिक नीतियों में मुद्रास्फीति नियंत्रण हेतु)
9. **Inclination towards** (Phrase)
tendency · की ओर झुकाव
10. **Policy tightening** (Noun)
restriction · नीतिगत कठोरता
11. **Stop short of** (Verb)
refrain from · कदम उठाने से ठीक पहले रुक जाना
12. **Draw attention to** (Phrase)
highlight · ध्यान आकर्षित करना
13. **Pegged at** (Phrase)
fixed at · पर नियत या निर्धारित
14. **Stimulating** (Verb)
boosting · प्रोत्साहित करना / गति देना
15. **Neutral stance** (Noun)
impartial position · तटस्थ रुख
16. **Resilient** (Adjective)
tough · लचीला / आघात सहने योग्य
17. **Sustained** (Adjective)
continuous · निरंतर / दीर्घकालिक
18. **Robust** (Adjective)
strong · मजबूत / हट-पुष्ट
19. **Grapple with** (Verb)
struggle with · से जुझना / निपटना
20. **Basis points** (Noun)
hundredth-percent · ब्याज दर मापने की इकाई (एक प्रतिशत का सौवां हिस्सा)
21. **Trajectory** (Noun)
path · प्रक्षेप पथ / विकास का मार्ग
22. **Shed light on** (Phrase)
clarify · प्रकाश डालना / स्पष्ट करना
23. **Underlying** (Adjective)
fundamental · अंतर्निहित / बुनियादी

🔔 Daily Revision

Detailed definitions & grammar rules on Page 8.

➔ Join Ez Editorials

Published: 2026-08-23 · Source: The Indian Express

EDITORIAL STANCE & SUMMARY

TONE: ANALYTICAL (CRITICALLY EXAMINING)

The author adopts an analytical tone to scrutinise the apparent contradiction between the Reserve Bank of India's dovish public rate decision and the hawkish sentiments revealed in its meeting minutes. By evaluating growth resilience alongside negative forward real interest rates, the piece argues that conflicting central bank signals must eventually give way to clear policy adjustments as inflation data evolves.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Benchmark NOUN Neutral	मानक / मानदंड A standard, point of reference, or criterion against which things can be evaluated.	touchstone, yardstick, criterion	aberration, anomaly, deviation
Memory Hook: Bench + mark: a permanent mark etched on a bench or stone against which other measures are compared.				
2	Dovish ADJECTIVE Positive	नरम दल का / उदारवादी (आर्थिक नीति में) Favouring economic policies that promote growth and employment, typically through lower interest rates.	accommodative, pacifist, expansionary	hawkish, aggressive, contractionary
Memory Hook: Dove is a symbol of peace — dovish monetary policy prefers calm, low interest rates over aggressive hikes.				
3	Imminent ADJECTIVE Neutral	सन्निकट / शीघ्र होने वाला About to happen or occur at any moment; impending.	forthcoming, approaching, looming	distant, remote, deferred
Memory Hook: Imminent sounds like 'in a minute' — something about to happen in a very short time.				
4	Projected VERB Neutral	अनुमानित / प्रक्षेपित Estimated, forecast, or planned on the basis of current trends and data.	forecast, estimated, extrapolated	verified, recorded, confirmed
Memory Hook: A projector throws an image forward; 'projected' throws estimates into the future.				
5	Divergence NOUN Negative	विचलन / भिन्नता A difference, variation, or parting of the ways between two or more things.	discrepancy, disparity, variance	convergence, concurrence, harmony
Memory Hook: Di (two) + verge (turn) — turning into two separate paths away from each other.				
6	Striking ADJECTIVE Positive	आश्चर्यजनक / विशिष्ट रूप से ध्यान खींचने वाला Attracting attention or notice; remarkable and conspicuous.	conspicuous, salient, prominent	inconspicuous, unremarkable, ordinary
Memory Hook: Something that 'strikes' your eye instantly because of how obvious or remarkable it is.				
7	Hawkishness NOUN Neutral	सख्ती / आक्रामकता (आर्थिक नीतियों में मुद्रास्फीति नियंत्रण हेतु) An advocacy for aggressive, tightening fiscal or monetary policies, especially raising interest rates to curb inflation.	rigidity, inflexibility, aggressiveness	dovishness, leniency, accommodativeness
Memory Hook: A hawk is a sharp, aggressive predatory bird — hawkishness refers to an aggressive stance against inflation.				
8	Policy tightening NOUN Neutral	नीतिगत कठोरता The process by which a central bank raises interest rates and reduces money supply to curb inflation.	monetary contraction, fiscal restraint, credit squeeze	policy easing, monetary accommodation, quantitative easing
Memory Hook: Tightening the purse strings: reducing the flow of money in an economy by raising rates.				
9	Stimulating VERB Positive	प्रोत्साहित करना / गति देना Encouraging or boosting the development, growth, or vigour of an economic activity.	galvanising, invigorating, spurring	dampening, stifling, inhibiting
Memory Hook: Stimulate acts like a stimulus or espresso shot to wake up a sluggish economy.				
10	Resilient ADJECTIVE Positive	लचीला / आघात सहने योग्य Able to withstand, endure, or recover quickly from difficult conditions and shocks.	tenacious, buoyant, impervious	vulnerable, fragile, susceptible
Memory Hook: Think of a spring that recoils and bounces back quickly after being compressed.				
11	Sustained ADJECTIVE Positive	निरंतर / दीर्घकालिक Continuing for an extended period without interruption or diminution.	unremitting, protracted, incessant	intermittent, sporadic, fleeting
Memory Hook: Sustain = to keep going without falling down over an extended period.				
12	Robust ADJECTIVE Positive	मजबूत / हट-पुष्ट Strong, healthy, vigorous, and unlikely to fail or weaken.	sturdy, vigorous, flourishing	feeble, frail, anaemic
Memory Hook: Sounds like 'robot' — sturdy, durable, and not easily broken down by strain.				
13	Underlying ADJECTIVE Neutral	अंतर्निहित / बुनियादी Fundamental, essential, or serving as the real but often concealed foundation of something.	intrinsic, basal, rudimentary	superficial, extrinsic, incidental
Memory Hook: Under + lying = lying beneath the surface, forming the real base of what is visible.				

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

Inclination towards (की ओर झुकाव): A person's natural tendency, predisposition, or preference to act or feel in a particular way.
Pegged at (पर नियत या निर्धारित): Fixed, anchored, or established at a specified price, rate, or level.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

Unanimously (सर्वसम्मति से): With the complete agreement and consent of all individuals involved.
Basic points (ब्याज दर मापने की इकाई (एक प्रतिशत का सौवां हिस्सा)): A standard financial unit of measure equal to one-hundredth of one percentage point (0.01%).
Trajectory (प्रक्षेप पथ / विकास का मार्ग): The path followed by a moving object or the path of development of an event or variable over time.

PHRASAL VERBS

Stop short of (कदम उठाने से ठीक पहले रुक जाना): To decide not to do or say something, although one was very close to doing it.
Grapple with (से जुझना / निपटना): To struggle to deal with, understand, or overcome a complex problem or difficulty.

IDIOMS & PHRASES

Draw attention to (ध्यान आकर्षित करना): To direct someone's focus, awareness, or notice towards a particular matter.
Neutral stance (तटस्थ रुख): A central bank posture that neither stimulates nor restricts economic growth and inflation.
Shed light on (प्रकाश डालना / स्पष्ट करना): To provide explanation or information that helps people understand a confusing or obscure situation.

Marathi language mandate for cabs, autos is a wrong turn

2026-08-23 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

Coming at a time when public transport is **plagued by**¹ **pressing**² issues of affordability and accessibility, the implementation of the Marathi language requirement for auto-rickshaw and taxi drivers in Maharashtra is both irrational and unconstitutional. It is part of a larger **backsliding**³ **into**⁴ narrow linguistic politics. This has been evident in the state for some time, from the **back and forth**⁵ on the three-language-policy in schools, the Hindi “**imposition**⁶” **bogey**⁷ **whipped up**⁸ by the Shiv Sena (UBT), to the incidents of **hooliganism**⁹ unleashed by the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena, which has **cast itself as**¹⁰ a “protector” of Marathi pride. The state transport department has justified the new move on the ground that drivers should be able to understand basic instructions and communicate with passengers in the state’s native language. Nine years after the Bombay High Court **set aside**¹¹ an attempt to make **proficiency**¹² in Marathi compulsory for auto-rickshaw permits, the latest move raises the same fundamental question: Why should linguistic **assimilation**¹³ be necessary for employability? The government has said that drivers found **lacking**¹⁴ functional knowledge of Marathi will first receive a notice, giving them a month to learn the language. If they fail, their driving licence and Public Service Vehicle (PSV) badge may be suspended for up to three months, with repeated violations resulting in permanent cancellation of licences. These penalties are part of the Maharashtra Motor Vehicle (Third Amendment) Rules, 2026, notified on August 12, with the language **proficiency**¹² deadline earlier extended from May 1 to August 15. The amended rules extend the language requirement to app-based cab drivers and vehicle permit holders. The language mandate ignores what makes Mumbai work. Dictating linguistic **proficiency**¹², making livelihoods dependent on it, tilts the field against migrants whose labour sustains urban economies. Transport systems, particularly in constantly expanding megacities like Mumbai, depend on flexibility, scale, and the willingness of workers to follow opportunities wherever they may be. More fundamentally, it undermines the constitutional guarantee of freedom of mobility, which gives citizens the right to reside and settle in any part of India and practise any profession or occupation there. The choice before the state is clear: Pursue inclusive growth while securing constitutional freedoms, or indulge **insular**¹⁸ impulses that shrink possibilities of growth and **cramp**¹⁹ individual liberties. Maharashtra’s language mandate is a turn in the wrong direction. It must be rolled back.

VOCABULARY 101

- 1. Plagued by** (Verb)
troubled by · ग्रस्त होना
- 2. Pressing** (Adjective)
urgent · अति आवश्यक
- 3. Backsliding** (Noun)
relapse · पतन
- 4. Backsliding into** (Verb)
falling back to · पुनः बुरी स्थिति में गिरना
- 5. Back and forth** (Idiom)
oscillation · तर्क-वितर्क
- 6. Imposition** (Noun)
forcing · थोपना
- 7. Bogey** (Noun)
threat · काल्पनिक डर
- 8. Whipped up** (Phrasal Verb)
provoked · भड़काना
- 9. Hooliganism** (Noun)
rowdiness · गुंडागर्दी
- 10. Cast itself as** (Phrasal Verb)
portrayed as · खुद को प्रस्तुत करना
- 11. Set aside** (Phrasal Verb)
annulled · रद्द करना
- 12. Proficiency** (Noun)
skill · दक्षता
- 13. Assimilation** (Noun)
integration · आत्मसातीकरण
- 14. Lacking** (Adjective)
deficient · कम होना
- 15. Tilt the field against** (Idiom)
disadvantage · अन्यायपूर्ण स्थिति पैदा करना
- 16. Livelihood** (Noun)
income source · आजीविका
- 17. Undermine** (Verb)
weaken · कमज़ोर करना
- 18. Insular** (Adjective)
narrow-minded · संकीर्ण विचार वाला
- 19. Cramp** (Verb)
restrict · बाधा डालना
- 20. Wrong turn** (Idiom)
mistake · गलत राह चुनना
- 21. Roll back** (Phrasal Verb)
reverse · वापस लेना

🔔 Daily Revision

Detailed definitions & grammar rules on Page 10.

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EDITORIAL STANCE & SUMMARY

TONE: CRITICAL (SHARPLY DISAPPROVING)

The author adopts a critical tone to censure the Maharashtra government's mandate requiring taxi and auto-rickshaw drivers to possess functional knowledge of Marathi. The editorial argues that forcing linguistic proficiency on transport workers is both irrational and unconstitutional, as it unfairly penalises migrant labourers and restricts freedom of mobility. Ultimately, the author demands an immediate rollback of the policy to safeguard constitutional rights and foster inclusive economic growth.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Pressing ADJECTIVE Negative	अति आवश्यक Requiring immediate action or attention; critically urgent.	urgent, paramount, exigent	trivial, negligible, unimportant
Memory Hook: Something pressing down on you requires immediate attention before it causes harm.				
2	Backsliding NOUN Negative	पतन Relapsing into bad ways, worse conditions, or lower standards.	regression, relapse, deterioration	progress, advancement, improvement
Memory Hook: Sliding backwards down a hill after making hard progress towards the summit.				
3	Imposition NOUN Negative	थोपना The forcing of an unwelcome measure, rule, or belief upon people.	enforcement, infliction, dictation	removal, withdrawal, exemption
Memory Hook: Impose = placing an unwelcome burden on someone against their consent.				
4	Bogey NOUN Negative	काल्पनिक डर Something that causes fear or alarm, often exaggerated or illusory.	spectre, phantom, bugbear	comfort, solace, reassurance
Memory Hook: Sounds like bogeyman — an imagined threat created to instil fear.				
5	Proficiency NOUN Positive	दक्षता A high degree of competence, skill, or expertise in a specific domain.	competence, mastery, expertise	incompetence, ineptitude, clumsiness
Memory Hook: Pro + efficient = displaying mastery and skill in a particular area.				
6	Lacking ADJECTIVE Negative	कम होना Deficient in a necessary quality, skill, or attribute.	deficient, wanting, inadequate	sufficient, abundant, adequate
Memory Hook: A lack of ingredients leaves a dish incomplete and deficient.				
7	Livelihood NOUN Positive	आजीविका The means of securing the necessities of life such as income and employment.	subsistence, maintenance, living	unemployment, destitution, impoverishment
Memory Hook: Live + hood = the financial means necessary to sustain daily living.				
8	Undermine VERB Negative	कमज़ोर करना To lessen the effectiveness, power, or stability of something gradually.	weaken, subvert, sabotage	bolster, reinforce, strengthen
Memory Hook: Mining tunnels directly under a foundation causes the structure to collapse.				
9	Cramp VERB Negative	बाधा डालना To restrict or inhibit the development, freedom, or expression of something.	restrict, impede, constrain	foster, liberate, expand
Memory Hook: A muscle cramp restricts freedom of movement and prevents flexibility.				

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

Plagued by (ग्रस्त होना): Continually troubled, tormented, or distressed by something harmful or persistent.
Backsliding into (पुनः बुरी स्थिति में गिरना): Reverting or declining gradually into a worse state or undesirable habit.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

Hooliganism (गुंडागर्दी): Violent, disruptive, or unruly behaviour carried out by troublemakers in public places.
Assimilation (आत्मसातीकरण): The process by which individuals or groups are absorbed into the dominant culture of a society.
Insular (संकीर्ण विचार वाला): Ignorant of or uninterested in cultures, ideas, or peoples outside one's own sphere.

PHRASAL VERBS

Whipped up (भड़काना): Deliberately incited or excited strong emotions or public agitation.
Cast itself as (खुद को प्रस्तुत करना): Presented or portrayed oneself in a specific role or character.
Set aside (रद्द करना): Officially annulled, quashed, or declared invalid by judicial authority.
Roll back (वापस लेना): To reverse, rescind, or reduce the effect of a law, policy, or decision.

IDIOMS & PHRASES

Back and forth (तर्क-वितर्क): Repeated movement or debate between two places, states, or opposing opinions.
Tilt the field against (अन्यायपूर्ण स्थिति पैदा करना): To create an unfair disadvantage or bias against a particular group.
Wrong turn (गलत राह चुनना): A bad decision or course of action that strays from a correct or prudent path.

STUDY TIP: Pay special attention to the fixed prepositions and contextual connotation tags when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

TODAY'S
EDITORIALS

ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERYDAY



THANK YOU!



“

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